

IPL (Intense Pulsed Light) Treatments — Service Knowledge Document

What It Is

IPL (Intense Pulsed Light) is a non-invasive light-based treatment that uses broad-spectrum light to target and treat sun damage, pigmentation, redness, and uneven skin tone. Unlike lasers that use one wavelength, IPL delivers multiple wavelengths simultaneously, making it versatile for treating various skin concerns in a single session.

How it works:

- Light energy is absorbed by pigment (melanin) and blood vessels (hemoglobin)
- Heat destroys targeted cells without damaging surrounding tissue
- Stimulates collagen production for skin rejuvenation
- Pigmented spots darken and flake off over 1-2 weeks
- Broken capillaries are absorbed by the body
- Skin tone becomes more even and radiant

What it treats:

- Sun damage and age spots
- Brown spots and freckles
- Redness and rosacea
- Broken capillaries and visible veins
- Melasma and hyperpigmentation
- Uneven skin tone
- Large pores
- Fine lines (through collagen stimulation)

Key benefits:

- Treats multiple concerns simultaneously
- Minimal downtime
- Safe and effective
- Progressive, natural-looking results
- Stimulates collagen for anti-aging
- Quick treatment sessions
- Safe for most skin types (lighter tones)

Treatment Areas & Pricing

Full Face — \$400

- Entire facial area
- Forehead, cheeks, nose, chin
- Around mouth and eyes
- Best for: Overall facial rejuvenation, sun damage, pigmentation

****Face & Neck — \$500****

- Everything in Full Face treatment
- Plus complete neck area
- Best for: Comprehensive rejuvenation, chest wrinkles (décolleté lines)

****Chest (Décolleté) — \$300****

- Upper chest area
- Targets sun damage and age spots on chest
- Best for: "Sun spots," age spots, uneven chest tone

****Hands — \$50****

- Back of hands
- Targets age spots and sun damage
- Best for: Hand rejuvenation, age spot removal

****Can combine areas**** for comprehensive treatment at package pricing

Who It's For

****Ideal candidates:****

- Fair to medium skin tones (Fitzpatrick I-III)
- Adults with sun damage or age spots
- People with rosacea or facial redness
- Those with uneven skin tone
- Anyone wanting to reverse signs of aging
- People seeking non-invasive skin rejuvenation

****Perfect for treating:****

- Brown spots from sun exposure
- Freckles (if desired)
- Redness from rosacea
- Broken capillaries
- Uneven pigmentation
- Dull, tired-looking skin
- Fine lines and texture
- Age spots on hands

****Great if you:****

- Have sun-damaged skin
- Want to look more refreshed
- Prefer minimal downtime treatments
- Are willing to commit to sun protection
- Can avoid sun for 2 weeks before/after

Who Should NOT Get It

Avoid IPL if you have:

- Very dark skin (Fitzpatrick V-VI) — risk of pigmentation changes
- Recent sun exposure or active tan (wait 4 weeks)
- Sunburn in treatment area
- History of keloid scarring
- Active acne or skin infections
- Melasma (can worsen)
- Photosensitivity disorders

Postpone treatment if you:

- Are pregnant or breastfeeding
- Recently used self-tanner (wait 2 weeks)
- Have been in the sun (wait 2-4 weeks)
- Are taking photosensitizing medications
- Recently had chemical peels or laser (wait 2-4 weeks)

Medications that may interfere:

- Accutane (wait 6 months after stopping)
- Photosensitizing antibiotics (doxycycline, tetracycline)
- Some acne medications
- Blood thinners (may increase bruising)

Skin tone considerations:

- Works best on fair to medium skin tones
- Not recommended for very dark skin (risk of hypopigmentation)
- Darker skin tones may be better candidates for other treatments

****Always disclose medications and sun exposure during consultation.****

Typical Session Length

****20-45 minutes**** depending on treatment area

Breakdown:

- Consultation and skin assessment: 5-10 minutes (first visit)
- Skin prep and cooling gel application: 5 minutes
- Treatment: 10-30 minutes (varies by area)
- Post-treatment cooling and instructions: 5 minutes

What to expect during treatment:

- Sensation of light snapping or rubber band flicks
- Slight warmth or heat

- Cooling technology minimizes discomfort
- Generally well-tolerated with minimal discomfort

Typical Downtime

****Minimal downtime**** with gradual improvement

****Immediately after:****

- Redness similar to mild sunburn (lasts 2-12 hours)
- Warmth in treated area
- Possible swelling (mild, resolves quickly)
- Treated spots may appear darker initially (this is good!)

****Days 1-3:****

- Redness fading
- Brown spots darkening ("peppering" or "coffee grounds" appearance)
- Skin may feel slightly rough
- Mild flaking possible

****Days 3-10:****

- Darkened spots begin flaking off
- Gradual lightening of pigmentation
- Skin texture smoothing
- Redness from vessels fading

****Days 10-14:****

- Most visible improvement
- Clearer, more even skin tone
- Continued collagen stimulation

****Return to normal activities:**** Immediately

****Return to exercise:**** 24 hours

****Makeup application:**** Immediately after (mineral makeup recommended)

****Results timeline:****

- ****1-2 weeks:**** Initial pigment clearing
- ****2-4 weeks:**** Continued improvement and brightening
- ****Full results:**** After 3-5 treatments spaced 3-4 weeks apart
- ****Maintenance:**** 1-2 times per year

What Results People Often Notice

****After first treatment:****

- Brighter, more radiant complexion

- Reduced appearance of brown spots
- Decreased redness
- More even skin tone
- Subtle improvement in texture

****After 3-5 treatments (full series):****

- Significant reduction in sun spots and age spots
- Dramatic improvement in redness and rosacea
- Much more even, uniform skin tone
- Reduced appearance of fine lines
- Overall rejuvenated, youthful appearance
- Clearer, healthier-looking skin

****Long-term benefits:****

- Continued collagen production
- Maintained clarity with sun protection
- Better skin texture
- Younger-looking skin

****What it does NOT do:****

- Remove deep wrinkles (consider fillers or RF microneedling)
- Tighten significantly loose skin
- Treat severe melasma reliably
- Work well on very dark skin tones

Aftercare Basics

****First 24-48 hours:****

- Avoid touching treated areas
- Apply cooling aloe or ice packs if needed
- Use gentle cleanser only
- Apply recommended moisturizer
- ****NO sun exposure**** (even brief)
- No makeup for 24 hours if possible
- Avoid hot showers, saunas, hot yoga

****First week:****

- Wear SPF 30+ daily and reapply every 2 hours outdoors
- Avoid direct sun exposure completely
- No tanning beds or self-tanners
- Don't pick at flaking skin (let it shed naturally)
- Use gentle skincare products
- Avoid harsh exfoliants, retinoids, acids

****First 2 weeks:****

- Continue strict sun protection
- Avoid other facial treatments
- No chemical peels or laser treatments
- Gentle skincare only
- Stay hydrated

****Long-term care:****

- ****Sun protection is CRITICAL**** for maintaining results
- Daily SPF essential
- Wear hats when outdoors
- Avoid peak sun hours
- Use quality skincare products

****To maximize results:****

- Complete full series of 3-5 treatments
- Maintain strict sun avoidance between treatments
- Follow all aftercare instructions
- Use medical-grade skincare
- Schedule maintenance treatments annually

****When to call us:****

- Blistering or burns
- Excessive pain or swelling
- Signs of infection
- Unexpected pigmentation changes
- Any concerning symptoms

Pricing Structure

****IPL Treatment Pricing:****

- ****Full Face:**** \$400
- ****Face & Neck:**** \$500
- ****Chest (Décolleté):**** \$300
- ****Hands:**** \$50

****Recommended treatment plan:****

- ****Series of 3-5 treatments**** spaced 3-4 weeks apart for optimal results
- Most see significant improvement after 3 treatments
- 5 treatments provide maximum correction

****Package pricing available:****

- Buy series upfront and save
- Ask about multi-area discounts

- Maintenance packages available

****Popular combinations:****

- Full Face + Hands: \$450
- Face & Neck + Chest: \$800
- Full comprehensive package (all areas, multiple sessions)

****Maintenance:****

- 1-2 treatments per year to maintain results
- Seasonal packages available

FAQs

****Does IPL hurt?****

Most people describe it as a light snap or rubber band flick—quick and tolerable. We use cooling technology to improve comfort. Discomfort is minimal and brief.

****How many treatments do I need?****

Typically 3-5 treatments spaced 3-4 weeks apart for best results. The exact number depends on your skin concerns and goals. Most see significant improvement after 3 sessions.

****What's the difference between IPL and laser?****

Lasers use one specific wavelength of light; IPL uses broad-spectrum light with multiple wavelengths. This makes IPL more versatile—it can treat pigment AND redness simultaneously. IPL is also generally gentler with less downtime than ablative lasers.

****Will my brown spots disappear immediately?****

No—they'll actually darken first (within 24 hours), then gradually flake off over 7-14 days. This is exactly what should happen! Be patient and don't pick at them.

****Can IPL treat melasma?****

IPL can sometimes worsen melasma, so it's not the first-line treatment. We may recommend other options. During your consultation, we'll assess whether IPL is appropriate for your specific pigmentation.

****Is it safe for darker skin tones?****

IPL works best on fair to medium skin tones (Fitzpatrick I-III). For darker skin (Fitzpatrick IV-VI), other treatments may be safer and more effective. We'll assess during your free consultation.

****When can I wear makeup?****

Mineral makeup can be applied immediately after if needed, but waiting 24 hours is ideal. Use clean brushes and gentle application.

****Can I go in the sun after treatment?****

NO! Avoid direct sun exposure for at least 2 weeks. If you must be outside, wear SPF 50+, a hat, and stay in shade. Sun exposure can cause pigmentation problems and reduce results.

****Will one treatment be enough?****

You'll see improvement after one treatment, but a series of 3-5 provides the most dramatic, long-lasting results. Think of it as progressive improvement with each session.

****How long do results last?****

With proper sun protection, results can last years. However, new sun damage can occur if you don't protect your skin. Annual maintenance treatments help maintain results.

****What should I avoid before treatment?****

- No sun exposure or tanning for 4 weeks before
- No self-tanner for 2 weeks before
- No photosensitizing medications
- No retinoids for 3-5 days before
- Arrive with clean skin (no makeup)

Next Steps

****Ready to reveal clearer, more even-toned skin?****

1. ****Book your FREE consultation:**** Online at harmonyaestheticsandwellness.glossgenius.com or call/text (240) 280-0020

2. ****During your consultation:****

- We'll assess your skin tone and concerns
- Determine if IPL is right for you
- Create customized treatment plan
- Recommend number of sessions needed
- Provide exact pricing
- Show before/after photos

3. ****Choose your treatment area:****

- Full Face (\$400)
- Face & Neck (\$500)
- Chest (\$300)
- Hands (\$50)
- Combine for comprehensive rejuvenation

4. ****Commit to sun avoidance**** 4 weeks before first treatment

5. ****Plan for series:**** Best results come from 3-5 treatments

****Questions?**** Text us at (240) 280-0020 or use the contact form on our website.

****Perfect for:**** Sun damage, age spots, redness, rosacea, uneven tone, broken capillaries

****IMPORTANT:**** You must avoid sun exposure completely before and after treatment. If you can't commit to this, IPL may not be right for you.

****Disclaimer:**** This information is for educational purposes only and does not replace a consultation with our providers. Individual results vary. IPL requires a consultation to determine suitability, especially regarding skin tone and sun exposure history.